

Next.js from scratch



components - the building blocks of a website 🧱

Components are one of the core concepts of React.

They are the foundation upon which you build UIs.

A component is nothing but a JavaScript function that returns JSX

Note that to make a route in next.js, you add a *page.tsx* file in a folder, but to make a component in react or in next.js, you build it with any name you want and add it to the route.



The 3 steps to build a component

Step 1: 'Default export' the function

```
export default function Header(){  
  
}
```

or,

```
const Header = () => {  
  
};  
  
export default Header;
```



Step 2: Write your logic

```
export default function Header(){  
  // No logic for now  
}
```

Step 3: Return JSX

```
export default function Header(){  
  return (  
    <div className={styles.headerContainer}>  
      <h1 className={styles.heading}>Find joke</h1>  
    </div>  
  );  
}
```



Naming a component

As you can see, the Header component starts with a 'H'.

Component names must always start with a capital letter.

If you do that React knows that it's component. Otherwise, it is treated as a HTML tag



Components within components

A component can also nest other components by importing them. This makes the nested component a "child" and the nesting component its "parent."



```
import Image from "next/image";
import styles from "../styles/searchbar.module.css";
const Searchbar = () => {
  return (
    <div className={styles.searchbarContainer}>
      <input
        type="text"
        className={styles.searchbar}
        placeholder="Search for a joke"
      />
      <button className={styles.searchButton}>
        <Image
          src="/search_icon.png"
          width={32}
          height={32}
          alt="Search icon"
        />
      </button>
    </div>
  );
};

export default Searchbar;
```

The Searchbar component

```
import Searchbar from "./Searchbar";
import styles from "../styles/header.module.css";
const Header = () => {
  return (
    <div className={styles.headerContainer}>
      <h1 className={styles.heading}>find joke</h1>
      <Searchbar />
    </div>
  );
};

export default Header;
```

The Header component



Using the component

Now that our Header component is ready, let's use it

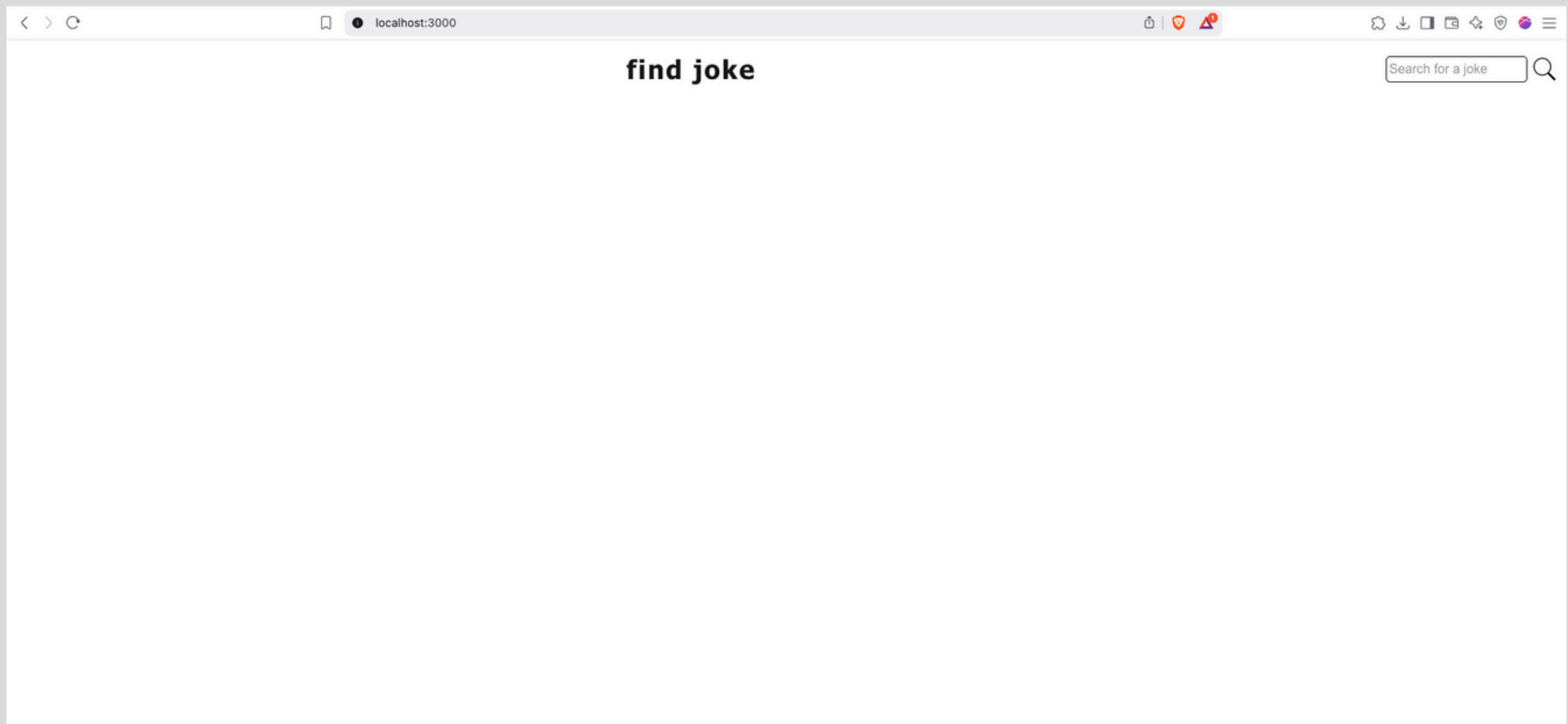
Just import it where ever you want to use it and add it there just like a HTML tag

```
import Header from './components/Header'
import styles from './styles/homepage.module.css'
const page = () => {
  return (
    <div className={styles.container}>
      <Header />
    </div>
  )
}

export default page
```



How it looks



The advantages of components

- ◆ **Reusable** - Build once, use multiple times across your app
- ◆ **Maintainable** - Update in one place, changes reflect everywhere
- ◆ **Composable** - Components can contain other components
- ◆ **Scalable** - Break complex UIs into manageable pieces
- ◆ **Organized** - Each component handles its own responsibility



Up Next: Props! we'll learn how to make components dynamic by passing data to it through props. Stay tuned 💪